

InkMaster Studio

A browser-based print-prep workflow for apparel graphics. InkMaster helps creators turn rough source art into DTG-ready assets with knockout cleanup, texture controls, underbase generation, mockup previews, and export tooling built around actual garment production needs.

From rough artwork to print-ready merch assets in one focused workflow.



Project Position

Shadewater Labs merch-production workflow

Public beta with a real browser-based operator surface

Built for DTG prep, previews, and production export

Overall Progress

76%

The beta is real, useful, and now focused on polish and product clarity.

Print Core

88%

The standardized print-master flow, DPI feedback, and garment prep are already strong.

Mockups & Export

84%

Underbases, mockups, PDF export, and production assets make it feel like a real operator tool.

Workflow Memory

71%

Batching, presets, checkpoints, and export history are working but still being refined.

Why It Exists

Most apparel graphics are not born print-ready. They need cleanup, resizing, texture preservation, mockups, and export prep before they can actually be sold or printed. InkMaster exists to compress those repetitive last-mile steps into one focused browser workflow.

Print-first cleanup

Remove black or white backgrounds, preserve distress and transparency, and shape edges for garments instead of forcing generic image tools to do specialized print work.

Production assets

Generate print masters, underbases, PDFs, SVGs, and mockup-ready outputs from the same session instead of bouncing between multiple tools.

Merch preview loop

Preview designs on multiple garment colors, compare placements, and produce sellable mockups without leaving the app.

Beta with real utility

The live product already solves a real operator problem: taking messy source art and turning it into something printable and merch-ready faster.

Core Workflow

InkMaster is strongest when the workflow stays tight: validate the artwork, prep it for the garment, preview it on real surfaces, and export both production files and merch assets from the same session.

01

Upload and validate

Start with raw artwork, normalize it into a 4200 x 5100 print master, and surface DPI feedback so weak source files get flagged early.

02

Prep the artwork

Choose the right garment-prep mode, remove black or white backgrounds, refine thresholds, preserve texture, replace colors, and shape the final print feel.

03

Preview on real surfaces

Check the processed design on artboards and garment mockups, compare colors, test placement, and confirm the asset still reads once it leaves a neutral editor background.

04

Export production assets

Download the final print file, create PDFs and underbases, or batch out mockup sets so the same workflow supports both production and merchandising.

Who It Is For

InkMaster is best for people who already know they need to print something and want a faster route from rough art to a sellable or production-ready result.

Merch creators

Independent creators who want to move faster from rough artwork to something they can actually list, print, and sell.

Apparel brands & print shops

Small operators who need repeatable DTG prep, mockup output, and better consistency without a bloated studio workflow.

Freelance designers

Designers who inherit messy files and need a faster route to production-ready graphics for client merch work.

Shadewater Labs ops

A live internal test bed for understanding where a focused merch-production product is already strong and where it still needs polish.

Why It Is Different

Not a general creative suite

The point is not to replace Photoshop. The point is to remove the repetitive merch-prep steps that most people end up doing inside Photoshop.

More than background removal

Background cleanup matters, but the real value is the whole loop: sizing, DPI checks, texture control, underbase generation, mockups, and export packaging.

More than a mockup toy

Mockups are part of the experience, but the real product sits earlier in the pipeline where artwork becomes print-ready in the first place.

Browser-first workflow

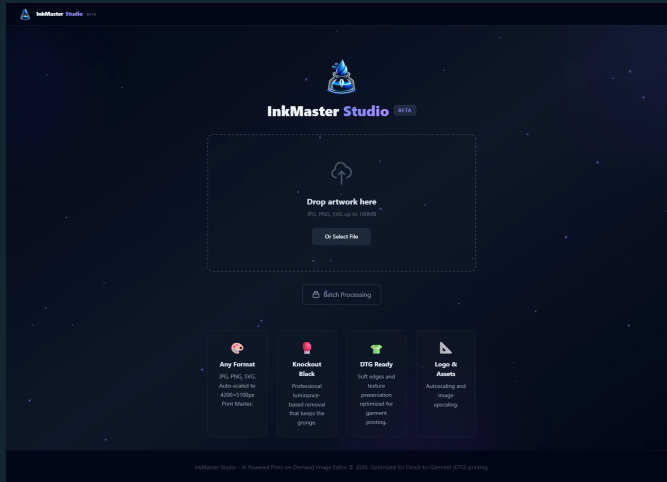
The key promise is speed and accessibility: do serious merch prep in a focused web workflow instead of getting buried in heavyweight desktop tools for every iteration.

Real Output Surface

The project already has real product surface and artifact outputs. These pages and previews matter because they show the tool is operating on more than theory.

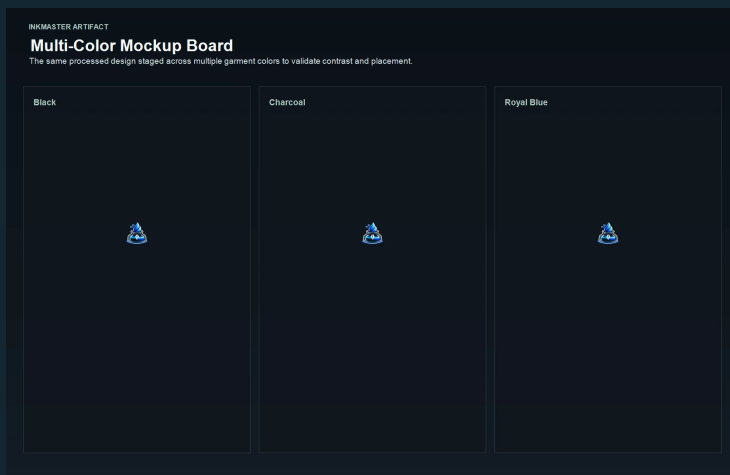
Public beta landing page

The live site frames InkMaster around batch processing, print-master sizing, knockout cleanup, and DTG-focused output instead of generic image editing.



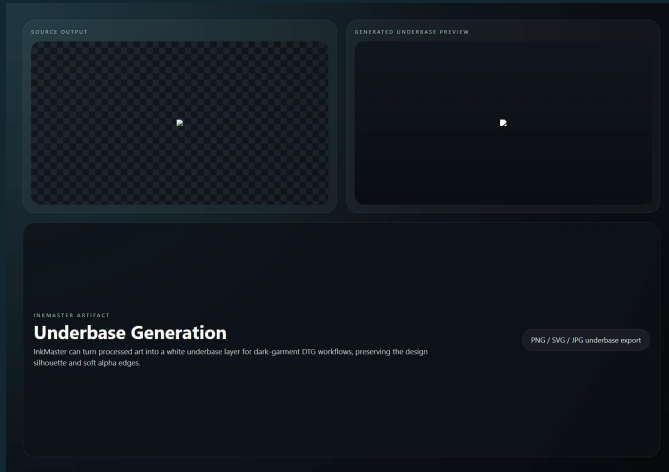
Multi-color mockup board

The same processed design staged across multiple shirt colors shows whether the asset survives contrast, placement, and merchandising realities before shipping.



Underbase generation preview

InkMaster can turn processed art into a white underbase layer for dark-garment DTG printing while preserving silhouette and soft alpha information.



Current Limits

- The AI-assisted editing path exists in the codebase, but the public beta still treats it as an inactive future-facing feature rather than a fully shipped operator path.
- The workflow is still tee-first today even though the product story points toward hoodies, hats, mugs, totes, and broader merch surfaces.
- The underlying tools are stronger than the onboarding and public explanation around them, which is why the explainer and Labs page matter right now.

What Comes Next

- Decide how to ship the AI editing layer in a production-safe way instead of leaving it as a beta curiosity.
- Expand beyond tees without diluting the clarity of the current print-prep workflow.
- Tighten onboarding, feature framing, and public messaging so the product clicks in a few seconds for new visitors.